PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Monday, June 23, 2025

Audit Committee

Informal Meeting Minutes

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, an Audit Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Virtual and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Director Patte Sullivan (Chair), Director Julia Brim-Edwards, Director Eddie Wang

Community Members: Caroline Zavitkovski (Absent: Jennifer Samuels)

Attendees:

Kara Bradshaw – Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Cathy Brady – Bond Performance Auditor
Janise Hansen – Senior Internal Auditor
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Advisor
Michelle Morrison – Chief Financial Officer
Stormy Shanks – Senior Director, School Modernization

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 11:04 am by Committee Chair Patte Sullivan. Attendees introduced themselves.

Presentation of the Year 6 - Bond Performance Audit results

Time: 11:08 pm

Bond Performance Auditor: Cathy Brady

Cathy Brady presented the Year 6 Bond Performance Audit results, highlighting progress, challenges, and recommendations across the 2012, 2017, and 2020 bond programs. It was noted that most 2017 bond projects are complete, with expected savings at Lincoln. There were recommendations around post-project evaluations and clearer contract terms in response to the ongoing issues with the Benson High

School modernization. While there have been budget and schedule challenges with the 2020 bond modernizations and the Center for Black Student Excellence, infrastructure and curriculum projects are moving forward. Other recommendations included improved workload tracking, improved oversight communication with the School Improvement Oversight Committee and the Bond Accountability Committee (BAC), improvements in BAC meeting documentation, and a stronger role for executive leadership in the implementation of outstanding audit recommendations.

Board members asked questions about project changes, communication improvements, recommendation status updates, and plans for the reallocation of remaining 2017 funds that resulted from cost savings. There was further discussion about the Benson modernization project, staffing plans, and how the Board could help support in resolving audit recommendations. Director Julia Brim-Edwards noted that questions regarding the Health and Welfare Trust remain unanswered and will be submitted for the record.

Public Comment

None

Other Business

Committee Chair Sullivan shared that the Senior Internal Auditor's performance evaluation, updated with received feedback, has been finalized and provided. It was noted that this is the final committee meeting for the 24-25 school year.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 12:42 pm by Committee Chair Patte Sullivan.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Statement for the Record

Director Julia Brim-Edwards:

Request for Health and Welfare Trust Audits from PPS District Staff

For more than a month, I have requested from PPS staff the audits of the Health and Welfare Trust and been denied access to them or been questioned about the request.

By way of this submission, I am requesting the audit again as well as additional information. I also asked if the Superintendent and/or any senior staff (who are not Trustees) reviewed the Trust audits prior my raising the issue and have not received an answer.

Since I have not received the audit, here are follow up questions related to the Trust Audits and the Trust Governance Document that was provided:

1. Have there been any amendments made to the Trust documents since it was signed in 2001? If yes, please send it to me. Are there bylaws, please send them to me.
2. It appears to be registered in the state of Oregon, can you tell me the name that it is registered under? Is it registered with the Sec. of State and DOJ? And, is there only one entity?
3. Who is the plan "Administrator"?
4. Who is the current secretary of the Trust? Other officers?
5. Over the last five years, please share the benefits that have been added, increased, decreased or terminated in whole or in part (Article 5.9)
6. What reports has the Trust required (Article 5.12) over the last five years? Please share them?
7. Article 6 says that the Trust shall maintain accurate records and accounts of all transactions which shall be available at all reasonable times for inspection by "any Party". According to the definitions (2.17) the District is a party. As a District director I am requesting the opportunity to inspect the records.
8. Article 6 also states that there is an annual Valuation of Assets available to the district. Please share the 2024, 2023, and 2022 valuations.
9. Article 9.1 relates to the annual certified audit and it says it shall be made available to the District. I am requesting the 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023 audits that were made available to the District or that should be available to the district.
10. What accounting firm conducted the audits?
11. Who is the Trust's attorney who is denying access to the audits; is the attorney being paid by the Trust?